

Photography services

This Agreement is a working template for one photography studio and its client. It is not legal advice and is not valid until counsel licensed in your jurisdiction has reviewed it. Complete every field, print, and sign. The date is not held until the retainer in Article V is paid.

Article I - The studio

STUDIO / TRADING NAME

EMAIL

ADDRESS

PHONE

Article II - The client

CLIENT 1 LEGAL NAME

EMAIL

PHONE

CLIENT 2 LEGAL NAME (IF ANY)

CLIENT 2 EMAIL

CLIENT 2 PHONE

Article III - The job

Type

☐ Wedding / elopement☐ Portrait / family☐ Commercial / brand☐ Other

EVENT / CAMPAIGN DATE

START TIME

END TIME

COVERAGE HOURS

VENUE / LOCATION NAME

CITY

FULL ADDRESS

GUEST COUNT (APPROX.)

PACKAGE NAME (DOOR / HOUSE / ESTATE OR YOUR NAMES)

SECOND SHOOTER

DELIVERABLES (EDITED RANGE, GALLERY TERM, SNEAK, ALBUM - NOT "UNLIMITED")

Article IV - Fees and payment

All amounts are in the currency named below and exclusive of any tax the studio must add by law. The shoot fee pays for making the pictures. Commercial usage, if any, is a separate line.

CURRENCY	SHOOT FEE	USAGE FEE (OR "NONE")	TRAVEL / LODGING	SECOND SHOOTER FEE
EXTRA HOUR (BOOKED 7 DAYS OUT)	RUSH / OTHER	TOTAL AGREEMENT PRICE		
RETAINER % OF TOTAL	RETAINER AMOUNT	RETAINER DUE (DATE)	BALANCE DUE (DATE)	

Payment methods accepted (studio to complete):

The balance is due on the date above and in any event before gallery access is sent. Files, passwords, and RAW licences (if offered) do not leave the studio until the balance is paid in cleared funds. Late balances may pause delivery. Commercial jobs: usage may sit on the same invoice as the shoot fee or a separate invoice; both must be paid before finals are released for the licensed use.

Article V - Retainer and the date

The retainer is consideration for reserving the studio's inventory on the event date - in particular Saturday inventory for weddings. No date is held, and the job is not "Booked," until the retainer amount above is received in cleared funds.

If the retainer is not received within 72 hours of this Agreement being signed (or by the retainer due date, whichever is earlier), the studio may release the date in writing and this Agreement ends without further obligation, except that any funds actually received may be kept or returned as counsel directs in the reviewed version of this clause.

A retainer is not a refundable deposit unless the cancellation clause reviewed by counsel says otherwise. The retainer is credited toward the total agreement price.

Article VI - Cancellation and date change

Client cancellation. If the client cancels after the retainer has cleared, the retainer is retained by the studio as liquidated damages for the reserved date (wording and enforceability must be localised by counsel). Any paid balance for work not yet performed is handled as counsel specifies. Notice of cancellation must be in writing (email is enough).

Studio cancellation. If the studio cannot perform (illness, force majeure, or other cause), the studio will refund all monies paid for unperformed work and will make a reasonable effort to recommend a replacement photographer. The studio is not liable for the replacement's fees or for consequential loss.

Date change. One courtesy move is allowed if the new date is open on the studio board and falls within 12 months of the original date. A second move requires a new retainer. Peak-season Saturdays may be refused as a move without a new agreement.

CANCELLATION NOTES (COUNSEL / STUDIO)

Article VII - Client duties

The client will: (a) provide a truthful brief and, for weddings, a family-formals list no later than 14 days before the event; (b) name one decision-maker on the day; (c) secure venue permission, permits, and any required vendor meal; (d) tell the studio about a "friend with a camera," content creator, or second coverage before the day; (e) not request illegal, unsafe, or venue-prohibited work; (f) pay invoices when due.

If a formals list exceeds a workable 15-minute, roughly 20-frame block, the studio will cut the list with the client on the timeline call. Extra groupings after the block are a separate portrait session and are not included.

Article VIII - Preview, revisions, and gallery

Turnaround (unless a rush fee is paid): portraits - sneak 48-72 hours, full 10-14 days; weddings - sneak 5-7 days (10-20 images), full 5-7 weeks; commercial - as written in the deliverables field.

Preview includes two revision rounds: (1) cull - drop or keep from the preview set, no global restyle; (2) up to five colour notes. Further rounds are invoiced at the extra-revision fee below before files are opened. The following are not revisions: new poses that were not shot; "edit like this influencer"; a RAW dump; extra coverage hours that did not happen.

EXTRA REVISION FEE (ROUND 3+)

GALLERY ONLINE (MONTHS)

SNEAK WITHIN (DAYS)

Gallery access (password or link) is sent when the balance is Paid. Personal print-release for the client's private and social use is included unless the job is commercial. The studio does not deliver a USB as the only copy. Dual backup is made before leaving the venue where reasonably possible.

Article IX - Copyright and usage

Unless a buyout is written below and paid, the studio keeps copyright in the photographs. The client receives a licence:

Wedding / portrait: personal use, prints for family, and the client's own social profiles. Not for sale to press, not for a vendor's paid advertising, not for a brand campaign, without a further licence.

Commercial / brand: only the channels, term, territory, and exclusivity written in the usage field. Shoot fee is not usage. Organic social is not paid media. Sub-licensing to agencies or partners needs an express line. Category exclusivity, if bought, means the studio will not photograph a named rival for the exclusivity term.

USAGE LICENCE (OR WRITE "PERSONAL USE ONLY")

Buyout or assignment of copyright, if any, is 3-5x the shoot fee or as written, and must be paid before assignment documents are signed. Model and property releases for commercial talent and locations are the client's responsibility unless the studio is hired in writing to obtain them.

Article X - Weather, delay, force majeure

Outdoor coverage is weather-dependent. The studio will continue in reasonable rain with available cover; unsafe lightning, flood, or venue closure is force majeure. Delay caused by the wedding party, vendors, or venue that overruns the coverage window is billed at the extra-hour rate only if the studio can stay; the studio is not obliged to cancel the next booking. Neither party is liable for delay caused by war, epidemic, government order, or failure of a venue the client booked.

Article XI - Liability, insurance, and data

The studio carries (or the client may request proof of) public-liability insurance as required by the venue. The studio's total liability under this Agreement is limited to the fees actually paid, except for death or personal injury caused by negligence or any liability that cannot be limited by law. The studio is not liable for lost guest gifts, vendor no-shows, or images that could not be made because of venue rules, guest obstruction, or a late party.

The client is responsible for how guest lists, children's names, and addresses are stored once the studio has delivered. The studio will not sell that data. The client warrants they have the right to share any personal data they send.

RAW files are not included unless a raw licence line is paid. The studio is not a lockbox for the client's only copy after the gallery term ends; download during the gallery window.

Article XII - General

This Agreement is the entire agreement for this job and replaces prior emails about price except the written proposal attached or referenced below. Changes must be in writing (email is enough). If a court strikes one clause, the rest stays. Neither party assigns the job without consent, except the studio may use a named second shooter. Notice: the emails in Articles I-II.

GOVERNING LAW AND COURTS (CITY / COUNTRY)

PROPOSAL / LOOKBOOK REFERENCE (DATE OR URL)

By signing, each client who is named confirms they have authority to bind the couple, family, or brand. Two clients are jointly responsible for payment.

Signatures

Sign in ink or type the legal name and date. A typed name in the signature field is intended as an electronic signature where local law allows. Wet-ink originals may be scanned; either party may keep a PDF copy.

Studio authorised signatory

PRINTED LEGAL NAME / SIGNATURE

DATE

Client 1

PRINTED LEGAL NAME / SIGNATURE

DATE

Client 2 (if any)

PRINTED LEGAL NAME / SIGNATURE

DATE

No date is held, and no file is delivered, until money that matches this desk is in.

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